ADMINISTRATIVE TRIBUNALS

TRIBUNALISATION: SPECIALIST JUSTICE UNDER → ARTICLES 323A AND 323B → CAT JURISDICTION AND STATUTORY → CAT AND SAT INSTITUTIONAL → APPLICATION, PROCEDURE, POWERS AND → L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997)

Read the thick, pen-all from Stage 00 to the final one synthesis. Each card can a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVISE

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FULL • Pending user review • source generation g5 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00 TRIBUNALISATION: SPECIALIST JUSTICE UNDER CONSTITUTIONAL SUPERVISION

SPECIALIST JUSTICE UNDER CONSTITUTIONAL SUPERVISION · ROOT QUESTION · CAN SPECIALIST ADJUDICATION IMPROVE ACCESS AND SPEED WITHOUT CREATING · RATIONALE EXPERTISE · FLEXIBLE PROCEDURE · HIGH-VOLUME DISPOSAL · GEOGRAPHICAL ACCESS · LOWER COST.

ROOT QUESTION

Can specialist adjudication improve access and speed without creating executive-controlled courts? → RATIONALE expertise → flexible procedure

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ROOT QUESTION
- Can specialist adjudication improve access and speed without creating executive-controlled courts?
- RATIONALE expertise
- flexible procedure

POWER / PROCEDURE
- high-volume disposal
- geographical access
- lower cost.
- CONSTITUTIONAL SOURCE

CHECK / LIMIT
- 42nd Amendment 1976 → Part XIVA → Articles 323A and 323B.
- STATUTORY SOURCE
- Administrative Tribunals Act 1985 → CAT and enabled SAT arrangements.
- NON-NEGOTIABLE FLOOR judicial independence + natural justice + reasoned order

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- High-Court/Supreme Court constitutional review.
- MUST REMEMBER: Keep Article 323A administrative tribunals, Article 323B subject
- tribunals and the Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 institutionally distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MUST REMEMBER: Keep Article 323A administrative tribunals, Article 323B subject tribunals and the Administrative Tribunals Act, 1985 institutionally distinct.

01

STAGE 01 ARTICLES 323A AND 323B COMPARED

ARTICLES 323A AND 323B COMPARED · ARTICLE 323A PUBLIC-SERVICE RECRUITMENT AND SERVICE CONDITIONS. · ADMINISTRATIVE-TRIBUNAL DESIGN. · ARTICLE 323B LISTED SUBJECTS · TAX, LABOUR, LAND REFORM, ELECTIONS AND OTHERS IN TEXT. · APPROPRIATE LEGISLATURE WITHIN COMPETENCE. · SUBJECT-SPECIFIC TRIBUNAL/HIERARCHY. · COMMON HISTORY TEXT ALLOWED COURT EXCLUSION.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
ARTICLE 323A public-service recruitment and service conditions. law-maker: Parliament. administrative-tribunal design.	ARTICLE 323B listed subjects: tax, labour, land reform, elections and others in text. law-maker: appropriate legislature within competence. subject-specific tribunal/hierarchy.	COMMON HISTORY text allowed court exclusion. CURRENT LAW L. Chandra Kumar (1997): Articles 226/227 and 32 judicial review is basic structure.	TRAP enabling Article != automatic creation of a tribunal.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ARTICLE 323A public-service recruitment and service conditions.
- law-maker: Parliament.
- administrative-tribunal design.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- ARTICLE 323B listed subjects: tax, labour, land reform, elections and others in text.
- law-maker: appropriate legislature within competence.
- subject-specific tribunal/hierarchy.

CHECK / LIMIT
- COMMON HISTORY text allowed court exclusion.
- CURRENT LAW
- L. Chandra Kumar (1997): Articles 226/227 and 32 judicial review is basic structure.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TRAP enabling Article != automatic creation of a tribunal.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP enabling Article != automatic creation of a tribunal.

02

STAGE 02 CAT JURISDICTION AND STATUTORY EXCLUSIONS

CAT JURISDICTION AND STATUTORY EXCLUSIONS · SECTION 14 COVERAGE · UNION RECRUITMENT AND SERVICE MATTERS · NOTIFIED AUTHORITIES AND BODIES. · SECTION 2 EXCLUSIONS ARMED FORCES · SUPREME COURT OR HIGH COURT STAFF SECRETARIAL STAFF OF · PROCESS GATE COVERAGE · DEPARTMENTAL-REMEDY RULE

SECTION 14 COVERAGE

Union recruitment and service matters → notified authorities and bodies. → SECTION 2 EXCLUSIONS armed forces

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- SECTION 14 COVERAGE
- Union recruitment and service matters

POWER / PROCEDURE
- notified authorities and bodies.
- SECTION 2 EXCLUSIONS armed forces

CHECK / LIMIT
- Supreme Court or High Court staff secretarial staff of Parliament and State legislatures.
- PROCESS GATE coverage → departmental-remedy rule → limitation → Original Application.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TRAP public employment does not automatically create CAT jurisdiction.
- SECTION 14 COVERAGE

MECHANISM / VERDICT — PROCESS GATE coverage → departmental-remedy rule → limitation → Original Application.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP public employment does not automatically create CAT jurisdiction.

03

STAGE 03 CAT AND SAT INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE

CAT AND SAT INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE · PRINCIPAL BENCH + NOTIFIED BENCHES · CHAIRPERSON + JUDICIAL MEMBERS + ADMINISTRATIVE MEMBERS UNDER CURRENT · JURISDICTION COVERED UNION RECRUITMENT/SERVICE MATTERS AND NOTIFIED BODIES · STATE SERVICE TRIBUNAL MAY EXIST THROUGH STATUTORY ARRANGEMENT · STATES VARY AND SOME SATS HAVE BEEN ABOLISHED OR · EXCLUSIONS FOLLOW EXACT ADMINISTRATIVE TRIBUNALS ACT TEXT AND NOTIFICATIONS · NOT EVERY PUBLIC EMPLOYEE OR CONSTITUTIONAL OFFICE ENTERS CAT.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Principal Bench + notified benches.
- Chairperson + Judicial Members + Administrative Members under current law.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- JURISDICTION covered Union recruitment/service matters and notified bodies.
- State service tribunal may exist through statutory arrangement

CHECK / LIMIT
- States vary and some SATs have been abolished or not constituted.
- EXCLUSIONS follow exact Administrative Tribunals Act text and notifications

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- Not every public employee or constitutional office enters CAT.
- CONTROL appointments, tenure and service conditions must be stated with the 5 September 2026 caveat.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CONTROL appointments, tenure and service conditions must be stated with the 5 September 2026 caveat.

04

STAGE 04 APPLICATION, PROCEDURE, POWERS AND CONTEMPT

APPLICATION, PROCEDURE, POWERS AND CONTEMPT · PROCESS JURISDICTION CHECK · ORIGINAL APPLICATION · INTERIM ISSUE · REASONED FINAL ORDER · PROCEDURE NATURAL JUSTICE · FLEXIBLE PROCEDURE · NOT RIGIDLY BOUND BY CPC.

PROCESS jurisdiction check → Original Application → notice/reply/record → interim issue → hearing → reasoned final order. → PROCEDURE natural justice → flexible procedure → not rigidly bound by CPC.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PROCESS jurisdiction check → Original Application → notice/reply/record
- interim issue → hearing → reasoned final order.
- PROCEDURE natural justice

POWER / PROCEDURE
- flexible procedure
- not rigidly bound by CPC.
- POWERS summons

CHECK / LIMIT
- review/other statutory powers.
- CONTEMPT statutory power subject to governing law and constitutional review.
- LIMIT procedural flexibility is not freedom from evidence, fairness, reasons or limitation rules.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- flexible procedure

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT procedural flexibility is not freedom from evidence, fairness, reasons or limitation rules.

05

STAGE 05 L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997) AND THE CORRECT REVIEW CHAIN

L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997) AND THE CORRECT REVIEW CHAIN · ORIGINAL CONSTITUTIONAL DESIGN TRIBUNAL AS SUBSTITUTE FIRST-INSTANCE FORUM + · L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997) · HIGH COURT ARTICLES 226/227 AND SUPREME COURT ARTICLE 32 · EXCLUSION CLAUSES INVALID · TRIBUNALS MAY TEST VIRES OF SUBORDINATE LEGISLATION AND STATUTES · OPERATIVE CHAIN TRIBUNAL ORDER · TERRITORIAL HIGH COURT DIVISION BENCH

ORIGINAL CONSTITUTIONAL DESIGN tribunal as substitute first-instance forum + exclusion clauses. → L. Chandra Kumar (1997) → High Court Articles 226/227 and Supreme Court Article 32 review are basic structure → exclusion clauses invalid → tribunals may test vires of subordinate legislation and statutes except parent legislation limits.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- ORIGINAL CONSTITUTIONAL DESIGN tribunal as substitute first-instance forum + exclusion clauses.
- L. Chandra Kumar (1997)
- High Court Articles 226/227 and Supreme Court Article 32 review are basic structure

POWER / PROCEDURE
- exclusion clauses invalid
- tribunals may test vires of subordinate legislation and statutes except parent legislation limits.
- OPERATIVE CHAIN tribunal order → territorial High Court Division Bench → Supreme Court constitutional route.

CHECK / LIMIT
- TRAP routine direct appeal from CAT to Supreme Court is not the ordinary substitute for High Court review.
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Preserve L.
- Chandra Kumar (1997)'s first-instance tribunal role together with Articles 226/227 review by the territorial High Court Division Bench.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- exclusion clauses invalid

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP routine direct appeal from CAT to Supreme Court is not the ordinary substitute for High Court review.

06

STAGE 06 TRIBUNAL-INDEPENDENCE DOCTRINE ACROSS FIVE DECISIONS

TRIBUNAL-INDEPENDENCE DOCTRINE ACROSS FIVE DECISIONS · UNION OF INDIA V. R. GANDHI (2010) TRANSFERRED JUDICIAL · MADRAS BAR ASSOCIATION NTT (2014) · NATIONAL TAX TRIBUNAL DESIGN INVALIDATED; CORE JUDICIAL FUNCTIONS CANNOT · MADRAS BAR ASSOCIATION IV (2020) · TRIBUNAL RULES SCRUTINISED; SELECTION AND TENURE SAFEGUARDS REINFORCED. · MADRAS BAR ASSOCIATION V (2021) SHORT TENURE, AGE AND · ROJER MATHEW V. SOUTH INDIAN BANK (2019)

Union of India v. R. Gandhi (2010) transferred judicial work requires equivalent independence, qualifications and → Madras Bar Association NTT (2014) → National Tax Tribunal design invalidated; core judicial functions cannot be executive-dominated. → Madras Bar Association IV (2020) → Tribunal Rules scrutinised; selection and tenure safeguards reinforced.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- Union of India v. R. Gandhi (2010) transferred judicial work requires equivalent independence, qualifications and safeguards.
- Madras Bar Association NTT (2014)
- National Tax Tribunal design invalidated; core judicial functions cannot be executive-dominated.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- Madras Bar Association IV (2020)
- Tribunal Rules scrutinised; selection and tenure safeguards reinforced.
- Madras Bar Association V (2021) short tenure, age and executive override defects invalidated in the 2021 ordinance/Act line.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Rojer Mathew v. South Indian Bank (2019)
- Finance Act/rules route and tribunal independence examined.
- Madras Bar Association tribunal reforms (2025) reported 2025 INSC 1330 continues the constitutional control and directs institutional reform.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- LIMIT service-condition detail remains date-sensitive; doctrine is stable, implementation is not.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT service-condition detail remains date-sensitive; doctrine is stable, implementation is not.

07

STAGE 07 RATIONALISATION, ABOLITION AND ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE CONSEQUENCES

RATIONALISATION, ABOLITION AND ACCESS-TO-JUSTICE CONSEQUENCES · 2021 RATIONALISATION ABOLISH SPECIFIED APPELLATE BODIES · TRANSFER FUNCTIONS TO COURTS/OTHER FORUMS · COMMON SERVICE FRAMEWORK. · POSSIBLE GAIN LESS FRAGMENTATION · FEWER DUPLICATIVE BODIES · CLEARER APPEAL PATH. · POSSIBLE COST SPECIALISED EXPERTISE LOST

2021 RATIONALISATION abolish specified appellate bodies → transfer functions to courts/other forums → common service framework. → POSSIBLE GAIN less fragmentation → fewer duplicative bodies → clearer appeal path.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 2021 RATIONALISATION abolish specified appellate bodies → transfer functions to courts/other forums
- common service framework.
- POSSIBLE GAIN less fragmentation

POWER / PROCEDURE
- fewer duplicative bodies
- clearer appeal path.
- POSSIBLE COST specialised expertise lost

CHECK / LIMIT
- burden shifted to High Courts vacancies and transition delay
- access becomes geographically harder.
- SAT VARIATION abolition/merger differs by State and statute; no uniform live SAT map should be invented.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TEST pendency outcome + bench capacity + independence + user cost + transitional clarity.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TEST pendency outcome + bench capacity + independence + user cost + transitional clarity.

08

STAGE 08 CAT, COURTS, COMMISSIONS AND ADR DISTINGUISHED

CAT, COURTS, COMMISSIONS AND ADR DISTINGUISHED · CAT STATUTORY SERVICE ADJUDICATION · BINDING REASONED ORDER · HIGH COURT REVIEW. · HIGH COURT CONSTITUTIONAL COURT · WRIT/SUPERVISORY JURISDICTION · BROAD PUBLIC-LAW CONTROL. · COMMISSION INVESTIGATION/ADVICE/REPORT UNLESS STATUTE GRANTS ADJUDICATORY POWER.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE	POWER / PROCEDURE	CHECK / LIMIT	FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
CAT statutory service adjudication → binding reasoned order → High Court review. HIGH COURT constitutional court → writ/supervisory jurisdiction → broad public-law control	COMMISSION investigation/advice/report unless statute grants adjudicatory power. LOK ADALAT statutory settlement/conciliation → award based on compromise.	ARBITRATION consensual private adjudication → limited statutory challenge. DEPARTMENTAL APPEAL administrative reconsideration → not independent judicial adjudication.	TRAP specialised does not automatically mean tribunal; binding does not automatically mean court. CAT statutory service adjudication → binding reasoned order → High Court review.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- CAT statutory service adjudication → binding reasoned order → High Court review.
- HIGH COURT constitutional court → writ/supervisory jurisdiction → broad public-law control.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- COMMISSION investigation/advice/report unless statute grants adjudicatory power.
- LOK ADALAT statutory settlement/conciliation → award based on compromise.

CHECK / LIMIT
- ARBITRATION consensual private adjudication → limited statutory challenge.
- DEPARTMENTAL APPEAL administrative reconsideration → not independent judicial adjudication.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- TRAP specialised does not automatically mean tribunal; binding does not automatically mean court.
- CAT statutory service adjudication → binding reasoned order → High Court review.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP specialised does not automatically mean tribunal; binding does not automatically mean court.

09

STAGE 09 CURRENT JUDICIAL AND LEGISLATIVE STATUS CONTROL

CURRENT JUDICIAL AND LEGISLATIVE STATUS CONTROL · 19 NOVEMBER 2025 · 2025 INSC 1330 INVALIDATED SPECIFIED RE-ENACTED SERVICE-CONDITION DEFECTS AND · 9 MARCH 2026 ORDER SPECIFIED INCUMBENT CONTINUITY UNTIL 8 · AUGUST 2026 CAUTION ENACTMENT · OPERATIONAL COMMISSION. · USE GAZETTE COMMENCEMENT AND APPOINTMENT RECORDS BEFORE CLAIMING OPERATION. · CURRENT CONTROL

19 NOVEMBER 2025 → 2025 INSC 1330 invalidated specified re-enacted service-condition defects and directed a National Tribunals Commission. → 9 MARCH 2026 ORDER specified incumbent continuity until 8 September 2026 or maximum age. → AUGUST 2026 CAUTION enactment != commencement != operational commission. → Use Gazette commencement and appointment records before claiming operation.

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 19 NOVEMBER 2025
- 2025 INSC 1330 invalidated specified re-enacted service-condition defects and directed a National Tribunals Commission.

POWER / PROCEDURE
- 9 MARCH 2026 ORDER specified incumbent continuity until 8 September 2026 or maximum age.
- AUGUST 2026 CAUTION enactment != commencement != operational commission.

CHECK / LIMIT
- Use Gazette commencement and appointment records before claiming operation.
- CURRENT CONTROL: 5 SEPTEMBER 2026

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- 2025 INSC 1330 remains the merits baseline; the 9 March 2026 order continues specified incumbents only until 8 September 2026/maximum age.
- Parliament passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, but no official assented Act or commencement notification was located; do not call it operative.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Parliament passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, but no official assented Act or commencement notification was located; do not call it operative.

10

STAGE 10 EXACT PYQ DEMAND AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

EXACT PYQ DEMAND AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE · 2018 GS-II 15/250 COURT-JURISDICTION CURTAILMENT + VALIDITY + COMPETENCY. · 2019 GS-II 10/150 · CAT AS INDEPENDENT JUDICIAL AUTHORITY. · 2024 GS-II 10/150 · LOK ADALAT VERSUS ARBITRATION + CIVIL/CRIMINAL JURISDICTION. · 2025 GS-II 10/150 NEED FOR TRIBUNALS + ASSESS 2021 · EXECUTION THESIS

2018 GS-II 15/250 court-jurisdiction curtailment + validity + competency.

2019 GS-II 10/150 → CAT as independent judicial authority. → 2024 GS-II 10/150

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- 2018 GS-II 15/250 court-jurisdiction curtailment + validity + competency.
- 2019 GS-II 10/150

POWER / PROCEDURE
- CAT as independent judicial authority.
- 2024 GS-II 10/150

CHECK / LIMIT
- Lok Adalat versus arbitration + civil/criminal jurisdiction.
- 2025 GS-II 10/150 need for tribunals + assess 2021 rationalisation.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- EXECUTION thesis → law → mechanism → case → constraint → verdict.
- 2018 GS-II 15/250 court-jurisdiction curtailment + validity + competency.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EXECUTION thesis → law → mechanism → case → constraint → verdict.

11

STAGE 11 UPSC SYNTHESIS AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE

UPSC SYNTHESIS AND REFORM ARCHITECTURE · PRELIMS FIREWALL · 323A SERVICE · 323B LISTED SUBJECTS · CONSTITUTIONAL COURT · ARBITRARY FIRST INSTANCE · FINAL CONSTITUTIONAL WORD · PENDENCY CURE.

PRELIMS FIREWALL → 323A service != 323B listed subjects → enabling != creeling → CAT != constitutional court → flexible != arbitrary first instance != final constitutional word

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS / ARTICLE
- PRELIMS FIREWALL
- 323A service != 323B listed subjects
- enabling != creeling
- CAT != constitutional court
- flexible != arbitrary first instance != final constitutional word

POWER / PROCEDURE
- rationalisation != pendency cure.
- MAINS SPINE rationale → constitutional/statutory source → structure/jurisdiction
- procedure/powers → L. Chandra Kumar (1997) chain
- independence cases → rationalisation/access → reform.
- REFORM independent appointments body

CHECK / LIMIT
- secure adequate tenure
- transparent vacancies administrative autonomy
- national data/standards
- regional benches coherent appeals
- periodic performance review without decisional interference.

FEDERAL / RIGHTS IMPACT
- VERDICT tribunals are justified only as independent, accessible specialist courts under constitutional supervision.
- LEGAL/SOURCE LIMIT: Parliament passed the Tribunals Reforms Bill, 2026, but no official
- assented Act or commencement notification was located by 5 September 2026.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: VERDICT tribunals are justified only as independent, accessible specialist courts under constitutional supervision.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · S.P. SAMPATH KUMAR INITIALLY ACCEPTED TRIBUNAL SUBSTITUTION IF THE · L. CHANDRA KUMAR (1997) HELD THAT EXCLUSION OF HIGH · TRIBUNALS MAY DECIDE CONSTITUTIONAL QUESTIONS IN THE FIRST INSTANCE · THIS PROTECTS CONSTITUTIONAL SUPERVISION BUT ADDS ANOTHER TIER; SPEED · THE ACT RATIONALISED THE TRIBUNAL LANDSCAPE BY ABOLISHING SPECIFIED · IT ESTABLISHED A COMMON SERVICE-CONDITION FRAMEWORK FOR COVERED TRIBUNAL · THE SUPREME COURT'S MADRAS BAR ASSOCIATION LINE INSISTS THAT

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE / CASE
- S.P. Sampath Kumar initially accepted tribunal substitution if the alternative
- L. Chandra Kumar (1997) held that exclusion of High Court/Supreme Court judicial review
- Tribunals may decide constitutional questions in the first instance, but their
- CAUTION: This protects constitutional supervision but adds another tier; speed therefore

ADVANCED LIMIT
- The Act rationalised the tribunal landscape by abolishing specified appellate
- It established a common service-condition framework for covered tribunal
- The Supreme Court's Madras Bar Association line insists that tribunal
- On 19 Nov 2025 , the Supreme Court in 2025 INSC 1330 struck down the

COMPARATIVE NUANCE
- On 9 Mar 2026 , the Court made a separate continuity arrangement extending
- 2025 GS-II Q2 (10 marks, 150 words): "Comment on the need of administrative
- Thesis: Tribunals remain justified by specialisation, accessibility and potential
- Structure: need - constitutional limits - 2021 rationalisation - gains and

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels